

holds at 82%, a massive improvement over the Fold 6's 60%. That alone translates to a phone that doesn't get bogged down mid-session, especially during heavier multitasking or long gaming runs. The vapour chamber redesign ensures that you get a cooler, more stable experience all around.

BGMI runs at 88–90 FPS on Smooth + Extreme+ settings while Genshin Impact gets a consistent 58-60 FPS at the highest settings. Both feel glorious on the larger 8-inch screen, but it's not just about the frame rate, it's the immersion. Everything from recoil control to map awareness feels enhanced on the bigger canvas. There are minimal frame drops and no palm-searing heat. That alone makes it one of the best foldables for gaming, and much better than many slab flagships.

The 3DMark Wildlife Extreme hits 4,966 (a modest bump over Fold 6), while PCMark Work 3.0 now jumps to 18,576, up nearly 3.7% from the Fold 6. The Fold 7 flies through multitasking with fluid animations, drag-and-drop workflows in Flex Mode, and Samsung's DeX desktop interface work like a charm.

Despite no change in battery capacity, the Fold 7 maintains a battery life of 912 minutes in PCMark, slightly better than the Fold 6 despite higher performance output. That's a win for power efficiency, and credit goes to both the 3nm node and thermal tuning.

In daily use, that translates to around 6 hours of screen time with mixed usage: Slack, Chrome, camera, YouTube, and a bit of BGMI thrown in. Charging is still on the slower side for 2025, where a full top-up takes just under 1 hour 40 minutes, but 25W is Samsung being... Samsung. You do get wireless charging and reverse wireless for earbuds and watches, which is super convenient, especially for travellers.

CAMERAS

Like the foldable mechanism, the camera system is another part of the Fold 7 that quietly demonstrates its maturity. This year we get well-rounded cameras that deliver images that look



close to what your eyes see, without overdoing computational makeup.

The new 200MP main sensor is a step up and brings real-world gains in detail, tone, and dynamic range. In daylight, it's a treat: skies don't get over-saturated, greens stay grounded, and textures, whether it's buildings or trees, come through with impressive clarity. The colours are neutral and accurate, the dynamic range is wide without looking processed, textures hold up well and there's no excessive contrast trickery in sight.

Close-ups are another strength. Food shots, fabric, tiny textures, all pop with accurate subject separation and a soft, natural bokeh. Portraits are sharp, edge detection is tight and skin tones avoid both oversmoothing and saturation.

The 10MP telephoto lens does its best work when the sun's out. Zoomed shots are sharp enough at 3x with decent colour retention and you can read text on distant signboards without that mushy, smudged look. But once you shift to low light, it starts to unravel. Detail drops, noise creeps in, dynamic range tightens, and there's focus hunting. It's serviceable, but not flagship-grade.

Samsung's colour science this year is more balanced and true-to-life rather than boosted. It's a welcome change for purists or anyone who enjoys editing later, but folks looking for punchy, satu-

rated social media-ready shots might find it a touch too flat straight out of the camera.

Overall, it's a dependable camera system that doesn't shout, but knows exactly what it's doing, with a few caveats tucked behind the zoom.

VERDICT

After seven generations, Samsung has finally figured out how to make a foldable that feels like a natural extension of your daily phone use, not a science project. It's slimmer, lighter, and more pocketable. It unfolds to a larger, brighter display. And when you use it, there's finally a sense of fluidity in the hinge, the UI and the transitions that earlier Folds couldn't fully deliver.



Is it perfect? No. You're still paying Rs 1,74,999 for 25W charging, no S Pen support, and a camera setup that's good. But for anyone still waiting to take the foldable leap, this is the most refined, least compromised version of Samsung's vision yet.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Elite | RAM: 12GB | Storage: 256GB | Display: 20.24cm and 16.42cm rounded corners Dynamic AMOLED 2x displays | Refresh Rate: 120Hz | Display protection: Gorilla Glass Ceramic 2 | IP Rating: IP48 | Cameras (rear): 200 MP+12 MP+10 MP | Camera (front): 10 MP | Battery: 4400 mAh | Charging: 25W wired, 15W wireless

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